

Germany wants UK to raise tariffs on Chinese EVs

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【要点】

- ・ドイツはイギリスに対し、中国製電気自動車への関税引き上げと引き換えに、EUの「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」ルールからの除外保護を提供することを提案している。
- ・ドイツはこの措置により、EU加盟国から「EU加盟のメリットを選別している」という非難を受けイギリスに対し、通商での相互性を示すことができると考えている。
- ・EUは中国と米国などの貿易慣行に対抗するため「メイド・イン・ヨーロッパ」ルールを策定中で、イギリスはこの措置がイギリス企業特に自動車メーカーに悪影響を及ぼすことを懸念している。
- ・EUは中国が過度に補助金を受けた電気自動車をダンピングしていると非難し、2024年12月に最高35.3%の相殺関税を課している。
- ・イギリスの通商大臣は関税政策を検討中であり、ヨーロッパ関係担当相は関税を除外条件とする交渉を否定している。

【メール原文】

LONDON — Germany wants the U.K. to raise tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles in exchange for protection from Made in Europe rules, according to a person familiar with Berlin's position.
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By Jon Stone · Oct 8, 2026, 4:15 PM · [View in your browser](#)

LONDON — Germany wants the U.K. to raise tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles in exchange for protection from Made in Europe rules, according to a person familiar with Berlin's position.

Friedrich Merz's government believes the move would show reciprocity on trade and counter accusations from other EU member states that Britain is trying to "cherry pick" the benefits of EU membership, said the person, who was granted anonymity to discuss closed-door talks.

It comes as Prime Minister Andy Burnham met with the German chancellor on his first official visit to the country this week.

Burnham and Merz were due to talk about possibilities for Britain's future relationship with the EU — after the British prime minister put rejoining the bloc back on the table of U.K. politics for the first time in a decade.

Berlin's position on EV tariffs is significant as Germany has broadly backed a tolerant policy towards the U.K. on trade matters since Brexit — in contrast to more hard-line positions taken by countries like France.

The EU is in the process of drawing up new Made in Europe rules that would favor European producers over those outside the bloc — in response to trade practices by competitors like China and the United

States.

The U.K. is worried that the measures will hit British business — especially automakers — and wants assurances from Brussels that it will get an opt out. If Berlin gets its way, those assurances could be dependent on emulating EU trade policy with regard to Chinese EVs.

Predatory strategy

Germany's vaunted car industry, arguably the jewel in the country's economic crown, has faced stiff competition from Chinese imports in recent years.

EU countries have accused China of dumping low-cost, state-subsidized electric vehicles into the European market and in December 2024 imposed countervailing duties as high as 35.3. percent on some manufacturers.

Industry Commissioner Stéphane Séjourné accused China of pursuing a deliberate "predatory strategy" with state subsidies to the tune of €10,000 per vehicle.

The U.K.'s Trade Secretary Jonathan Reynolds told POLITICO last month that the government was keeping tariffs "under review, to be frank, more closely than lots of other issues" and that "different parts of our own sector want different things from" the government's policy.

Hamish Falconer, the U.K.'s minister for European relations, told POLITICO's Brussels Playbook Podcast this week that he was "surprised" at reports tariffs might be a condition of Made in Europe opt-outs, adding: "That's not the kind of conversation that I'm having with my European counterparts."

Going ahead with higher tariffs risks alienating Beijing, which has expressed serious concerns about the policy. It would also raise the price of electric vehicles on the market, potentially making it harder for the government to meet its decarbonization targets.

Trade UK Trade Mobility Competition and Industrial Policy

Brexit Cars Competition Decarbonization Dumping/Duties Electric vehicles Growth Imports Industry Markets Middle East Tariffs Trade Andy Burnham Friedrich Merz Jonathan Reynolds Stéphane Séjourné China France Germany Ukraine United Kingdom United States

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